MDM Request Hub — Two-Page Summary

Oct 22, 2026 · @Luo Chuan

Lives Group should move master data requests onto a request hub built on Microsoft 365. Modelled on 12 months of requests, setup time falls from 18 days to about 3, duplicates stop at the form, and the regional forecast error falls from 17.1% to 11.7%.

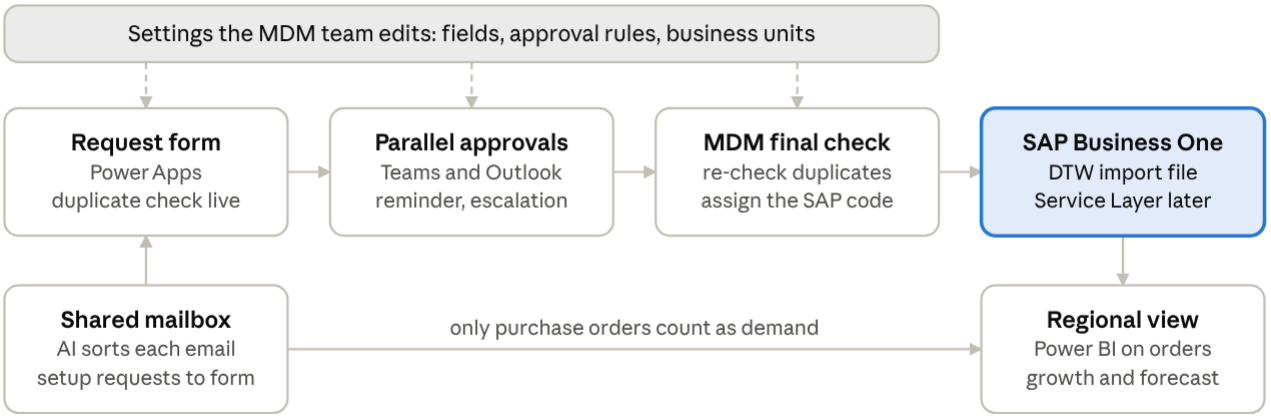
Prototype: luochuan91.github.io/lives-mdm-hub · **Demo video:** [YouTube link] · **Code:** github.com/LuoChuan91/lives-mdm-hub · Figures come from synthetic data (A1).

1. The problem: email makes setups slow and the data unreliable

New customers, items, vendors and cost centres reach SAP B1 by email in **18.0 days** on average (one in ten over 28.8), across 354 requests a year. 38% bounce back for missing fields, approvers work one after another, and nobody sees where a request stands. Ten customers exist twice, so duplicates look like new accounts and originals like lost ones; a Johor hospital filed under Singapore misplaces 2,887 boxes of Malaysian orders.

2. Our solution: one request hub, from form to SAP B1

One path from request to SAP B1; clean records feed the sales view



request flow · 4 steps to SAP B1, plus the shared mailbox and the regional view

- **A form that knows the rules:** fields follow the request type (a licence field only for regulated items); the live duplicate check found 10 of 10 duplicates in testing.
- **Approvals side by side in Teams and Outlook:** a reminder after 2 working days, escalation a day later; bank details masked until opened, every view logged.
- **Settings, not code:** fields, rules and units are lists the MDM team edits in minutes.
- **Into SAP B1, then the sales view:** after Priya's final check, a Data Transfer Workbench import file (Service Layer in phase 3); the regional view counts purchase orders only.

Why this, not the alternatives. A process fix alone (template plus tracker) is cheapest but enforces nothing and leaves duplicates. Commercial MDM software needs IT, licences and integration, and is oversized for one SAP B1 database. The hub fixes all four root causes on licences Lives Group already pays for.

3. Expected impact

- **Setup time 18.0 → 3.0 days** (9 in 10 within 4.7), from parallel approvals and reminders; bounce-backs 38% → about 5%.
- **Forecast error 17.1% → 11.7%** in a backtest, cutting under-forecasting from 13% to 2%; the Q4 plan for Product A rises about 1,700 kits.
- **Actions** (growth = July to September 2026 units ÷ April to June − 1, orders only): fast-track Indonesia's five waiting accounts (A +12%, B +11%); call Pattaya Bay, silent since 29 June (Thailand B −11%); widen Vietnam's instrument base (C +52%, three hospitals); offer instruments to 17 hospitals buying only A and B.
- **Inbox:** 96% of shared-mailbox emails sorted automatically, 97.6% of them correctly.

4. Business case and adoption

- **Cost about SGD 20.6k:** 156 hours from the MDM team and a power user (Power Apps form, SharePoint lists, flows) plus 10 days of outside help for the duplicate check; an SAP partner only in phase 3; no new licences in phase 1.
- **Return:** about 765 hours a year (0.5 full-time staff, SGD 42k), paying back in about six months; new accounts order 18 days sooner (about SGD 393k a year brought forward).
- **Rollout:** phase 1 (8 weeks) pilots customer and item requests with SPD; phase 2 adds all types, the duplicate service and Power BI; phase 3 writes to SAP B1.
- **Adoption:** approvals in Teams and Outlook; auto-reply with the form link; no email requests once a unit is live (SPD: 4 January 2027); unit champions; weekly usage.

5. Assumptions

A1 Synthetic data built to the brief: October 2025 to September 2026, 116 customer records (10 duplicates), 2,066 orders, 3,605 emails, 354 requests. **A2** Minutes per request, today → hub: MDM team 50 → 13, requestor 30 → 5, approver 10 → 4. **A3** Staff SGD 55 an hour; outside help SGD 1,200 a day. **A4** Hub approvers reply in 1.4 days; 5% of requests still bounce back. **A5** 8% of new customers are duplicates; 90% are caught; each costs 6 hours to fix. **A6** Forecasting takes 16 hours a month today, 2 with the hub. **A7** The phase 2 premium connector is not costed.